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studies where specialisation in renewable energy or solar PV can be pursued. Pandit Deendayal Petroleum

Some key players

Solar cells

- Bharat Electronics Ltd
- Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd
- Central Electronics Ltd
- Euro Multivision
- Hind High Vacuum Company
- Indosolar
- Jupiter Electronics
- Maharishi Solar Technology
- Moser Baer Solar
- Shurjo Energy
- Tata BP Solar India
- Websol Energy Systems

Solar modules

- Central Electronics Ltd
- Emmvee Solar Systems
- HHV Solar Technologies
- Maharishi Solar Technology
- Mitramax (Power Solutions Group, Apla)
- Moser Baer Solar
- Photon Energy Systems
- Premier Solar Systems
- Solar Semiconductor Photovoltaic
- Surana Ventures
- Tata BP Solar (India)
- Titan Energy Systems
- USL Photovoltaics
- Waaree Energies
- Websol Energy Systems
- XL Energy

Solar inverters

- Convergence Power Systems
- Delta Energy Systems
- Su-Kam Power Systems
- Truepower International
- Uniline Energy Systems

University has a School of Solar Energy which offers courses in solar technology. Many universities offer alternative energy sources as an elective for final year of the four-year graduate-level programme.

IIT-Bombay, SEMI Group and KPTCL conduct introductory or short-term courses for a week or two. These courses are not specific to power electronics but cover system design, integration, etc.

To bridge the short-term resource gap, SEMI India has launched a solar skill development programme in collaboration with the National Centre for Photovoltaic Research and Education (NCPRE) based at IIT-Bombay. These are short-term technical training courses, three days in duration, conducted by faculty drawn from IIT-Bombay and solar industry. SEMI India is also going to hold a short-term course on off-grid solar PV components and systems at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi, on April 11-13, 2012.

Career growth over the years

Entry-level positions start from trainee engineers in manufacturing, system and project design, installation, operation and maintenance, procurement, etc. You can progress from the level of assistant manager to manager and general manager level both in production and R&D.

A fresher or trainee engineer can earn Rs 20,000-25,000 a month. However, if you have graduated

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from a reputed engineering college or have a master's degree, you can earn anywhere between Rs 35,000 and Rs 40,000 a month depending on your individual skillset. Currently, professionals with eight to ten years of experience in the solar industry earn Rs 2-2.5 million per annum.

Key to success

The key to a successful career in the solar industry is "Learning by doing." You can do that by continuing research and training, attending conferences and events, joining local and national groups, reading industry magazines and websites, making personal contacts and volunteering to show commitment. In short, sound technical knowledge, awareness about latest developments and dynamics of the field along with a passion for renewable energy technology will help you get going. ●

The author is an executive editor at Efy